Improve the commute experience behind the rating

Prepared by Vivek Kumar | Evidence collected 29 October 2026

Recommendation: prioritize reliable app access and self-booking, remove interruptions to essential trip tasks, and assign an owner to every actionable complaint. Use review monitoring to identify where to investigate; confirm causes using internal telemetry before committing to a technical fix.

What the evidence says

Measure	Observed result	Interpretation
Employee app store snapshot	4.64 / 5; 115,574 ratings	Supplied snapshot at 08:37 UTC on 29 Oct; not a recent-review average.
Recent downloaded reviews	2,758 records; mean 3.84 / 5	1 Nov 2025 through 29 Oct 2026; self-selected review sample.
Low-rated reviews	746 rated 1-2 stars (27.05%)	A useful complaint pool, not the share of all users affected.
Developer reply presence	24 / 746 (3.22%)	Nine replies predate the current review timestamp. Presence does not establish resolution.

The brief describes ratings as lower than desired, but the observed employee-app score is not low in absolute terms. No target rating is supplied. I would agree a target with the team and focus first on recurring failures hidden by the aggregate score. The 4.64 store score and 3.84 sample mean measure different populations and periods; their gap is not proof of rating manipulation or a historical decline.

Decisions requested

Start now: assign an Engineering owner to access/booking reliability, a Product owner to interruptive prompts and trip visibility, and a Support/Operations owner to complaint follow-up. Validate safety reports immediately, regardless of frequency.

First delivery: within two weeks, ship a tested non-blocking feedback flow where confirmed feasible, instrument the booking journey, and operate a daily complaint queue. Treat effort and timing as planning assumptions pending code and telemetry access.

Source trail: supplied snapshots.csv; freshly collected ets_en.jsonl and collection metadata; baseline and trend outputs. Detailed sources and limitations appear on page 5.

DIAGNOSIS

Where users report friction

All 746 low-rated records have AI-assisted labels. Of these, 725 retain the original unverified AI labels, 20 received a second AI-assisted check, and one received an additional label. Counts below overlap because one review can describe several issues.

Theme	Reviews / 746	Likely investigation owner
Crashes, slowness and loading failures	137 (18.36%)	Mobile + backend Engineering
Tracking, ETA and trip information	89 (11.93%)	Mobile + location/platform teams
Login and authentication OTP	83 (11.13%)	Identity/backend + messaging provider
Booking, cancellation and schedule visibility	77 (10.32%)	Booking Product + Engineering + client configuration
Interface and redesign complaints	77 (10.32%)	Product + Design
Support complaints	65 (8.71%)	Support + transport Operations
Repeated or blocking prompts	48 (6.43%)	Product + mobile Engineering

Another 146 reviews are vague app complaints. They indicate dissatisfaction but cannot justify a specific fix. Safety has 14 labels; lower frequency does not imply lower severity. Routing, driver/cab and no-show complaints may involve software, vendors and client policies, so ownership must be confirmed rather than inferred solely from a category.

Read the complaint before diagnosing the cause

Booking: a 22 October review reports that the schedule says there are no shifts and booking is difficult [R1]. Possible causes include roster synchronization, client policy or an app defect; the review alone cannot distinguish them.

Interruptions: a 15 October reviewer says an old ride-rating prompt cannot be cancelled and prevents access to booking details [R2]. This supports a concrete usability investigation even though prompt complaints are less frequent than stability complaints.

Reliability and visibility: a 26 October review describes reloading while selecting cabs [R3]; a 16 October review reports stale cab locations and unhelpful support [R4]. These are reported symptoms, not reproduced defects.

Timing helps narrow investigation

June has the weakest monthly sample mean: **3.56**, with **92/273 (33.7%)** low-rated reviews, compared with 21.1% in May. July recovers to 23.2%, then August rises to 31.8%. Version 12.14.0 has 15/38 low-rated reviews; 12.17.0 has 44/143. Investigate release and service changes in these periods, without claiming causality. Version is missing for 271/2,758 records; October is partial.

ACTION PLAN

Protect the critical journey first

P1 | Reliable login and self-booking

Why first: access failures and failed bookings prevent the core journey from starting. Stability, OTP and booking are frequent themes, but their overlapping counts must not be summed as unique affected users.

Next-day work: Engineering and the transport desk reproduce the top examples across client accounts, app versions and network conditions. Add a trace ID across OTP request/delivery, roster fetch, booking submission and confirmation. Record error reason, latency, version and client identifier without logging OTPs or unnecessary personal data.

Implementation candidates: distinguish no roster, policy cutoff and server failure in the UI; preserve booking inputs on retry; reconcile ambiguous submissions and use an idempotency key to prevent duplicate bookings. Diagnose provider delivery versus app verification failures before changing OTP retry behaviour. Fix the leading crash traces rather than guessing from review wording.

Acceptance: automated journey checks cover expired login, empty roster, cutoff, timeout after submission and slow network. Retrying cannot create a second booking; confirmation must reflect the server state. Preserve a safe recovery path when an operation fails.

P2 | Unblock trip tasks and make tracking trustworthy

Next-day work: Product and mobile Engineering reproduce the blocking feedback prompt [R2]. Separate optional ride feedback from booking, tracking and boarding access; provide a working dismiss action and persist dismissal. Do not remove genuine safety checks as part of this change.

Tracking: trace the driver GPS update through ingestion and employee display. Show last-update time and an explicit stale-location state; agree a freshness threshold with Operations. Test reconnection, backgrounding and poor connectivity. Do not display a stale position as live or a precise ETA when its inputs are stale.

Acceptance: declining feedback leaves essential actions reachable. Delayed GPS becomes visibly stale within the agreed threshold. Track the complaint through both the driver and employee app before assigning blame.

P3 | Close the complaint loop

Start in parallel: Support triages actionable low-rated reviews daily, links related issues to Engineering or Operations tickets, and gives specific acknowledgements. Request trip details through a private support channel. Escalate safety concerns immediately; investigate no-show disputes using trip evidence and client policy.

Close with evidence: use statuses such as acknowledged, investigating, fix shipped and user-confirmed resolved. Never equate a public reply with resolution or condition support on changing a rating. Diagnose recurring transport-service complaints with the relevant vendor/client desk.

Prove improvement before claiming it

Window	Deliverable	Accountable owner
Days 1-3	Reproduce key complaints; review June/August incidents; baseline critical-journey telemetry; establish safety escalation.	Engineering lead + Operations lead
Days 4-14	Implement and test confirmed high-impact fixes; pilot dismissible prompts; daily complaint queue and weekly review report.	Mobile/booking leads + Product + Support
Days 15-30	Controlled rollout; compare eligible cohorts; review failures and roll back on telemetry regression.	Release owner + Product analytics
Days 31-60	Measure sustained experience improvements; refresh complaint sample and agree next priorities.	Product owner + customer transport desk

Proposed measures and targets

Targets below are proposals, not measured outcomes. Establish internal baselines during week one and revise thresholds with the owning teams.

Metric	Measurement / proposed target
Booking success	Confirmed unique bookings / eligible attempts. Reduce failure rate by 20% relative to the initial baseline within 30 days; monitor duplicate bookings as a guardrail.
Login and stability	OTP delivery and verification success measured separately; crash-free sessions and journey latency by version/client. Rollout must not worsen these versus a comparable control.
Prompt obstruction	Zero reproduced cases in the agreed test suite where optional feedback prevents booking, tracking or boarding access.
Complaint handling	Acknowledge 90% of new actionable low-rated reviews within two business days. Measure resolution separately in the internal queue.
External outcome	Track displayed store rating and 28-day low-rated review share with sample sizes. Seek a sustained reduction from a newly established 28-day baseline; do not promise a specific star increase.

Use the tracker repeatedly

Run **python tracker.py** weekly and after releases to refresh store snapshots and all three review datasets. Run **python tracker.py --offline --as-of 2026-10-29** to reproduce the submitted baseline. Outputs: out/metrics.json and out/reviews_tagged.csv. Scheduling is proposed, not installed.

The tracker flags stale collections, keyword spikes and versions needing investigation. Keyword counts are provisional and are not interchangeable with the report labels. Snapshot differences are net changes, not a distribution of new ratings. An as-of filter uses the currently stored review records; it cannot reconstruct historical edits.

Reproducible, with explicit limits

Collection: Python google-play-scraper, newest-first pagination, lang=en and country=in. On 29 October, collection returned 24,431 MoveInSync, 1,652 Safetrax and 7,226 Routematic unique review IDs. Requests ran to pagination exhaustion, which does not prove complete coverage. Review IDs are retained for audit; names and profile images were removed by the downloader.

Validation: no duplicate or missing IDs, missing dates or invalid 1-5 scores in the collected files. One MoveInSync record has empty text. The analysis window is 1 November 2025 to 29 October 2026 inclusive. Dates are used as supplied; review timezone is unspecified. Reviews may be edited and their dates should not be interpreted as immutable original-posting dates.

Recent review sample	Records	Mean	Low-rated with reply
MoveInSync	2,758	3.84	24/746 (3.22%)
Safetrax	110	2.89	56/56 (100%)
Routematic	690	3.53	215/215 (100%)

Peer results are descriptive, not a controlled ranking. Different samples, clients, users and review practices limit comparison. Reply presence is not resolution; nine MoveInSync replies predate the current review timestamp. The downloaded review count also differs from the store-reported count, so these denominators are kept separate.

AI and tools: Claude supplied the initial scripts and labels; ChatGPT assisted with debugging, analysis, the second 20-record check and report preparation. The candidate ran Python in VS Code and transferred sample labels through Excel. The second AI-assisted check agreed exactly on 16/20 label sets; this is agreement, not accuracy or independent human validation. Twenty checked records override original labels; one new trip-feedback label completes the 746-record set. Most labels remain unverified.

Testing: revised tracker reproduced the 2,758/746 baseline locally and on the candidate's machine. Additional checks covered monthly totals, missing-version count, empty summaries and stale-data warnings. The downloader ran successfully on the candidate's machine; the combined live tracker refresh has not yet been demonstrated end-to-end. Public reviews identify symptoms, not confirmed technical causes.

Public sources: Google Play listings requested by the collection scripts:

play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.moveinsync.ets

play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=in.mtap.iincube.safetrax.commuter

play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.routematic.employee

Audit records in data/ets_en.jsonl:
R1 fb5d7503-0d59-4fd6-849f-e159629d1ebd (22 Oct 2026)
R2 1b66b570-b9c5-4255-ab0d-4a990166868c (15 Oct 2026)
R3 c5279d19-41ad-458e-a9e8-12e736162e4e (26 Oct 2026)
R4 f7ae1a95-7a1f-4e35-925f-7ff1a99f6922 (16 Oct 2026)

Supporting files: data/*.jsonl and *.meta.json; data/snapshots.csv; out/report_labels.json; out/report_theme_summary.json; monthly_trends.csv; version_trends.csv; validation/manual_check_20.csv. Store snapshot is inherited from the supplied project; candidate collection independently showed approximately 4.64 later the same day.